BAHRAIN IMPORT TRADE 2025

Uncovering patterns, risks, and growth signals in Bahrain's 2025 import economy

ANALYST Yusuf Hakeem

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CLASS DAP-PT-16

SOURCE data.gov.bh — Official Bahrain Open Data

AGENDA

What We'll Cover Today

01 **Introduction**
Background on Bahrain's trade landscape and why this matters

02 **Problem Statement**
The core trade challenges we set out to investigate

03 **Objectives**
The four analytical questions driving this study

04 **Data Summary**
Dataset overview — 324,818 transactions, 221 countries

05 **Analysis**
4 deep-dive insights: countries, commodities, seasonality, growth

06 **Recommendations**
Actionable strategies for policymakers and businesses

07 **Limitations**
Honest assessment of data and model constraints

Bahrain & Import Trade — The Context

? Island Economy

Bahrain is a small island nation with limited natural resources, making imports critical to sustain both its population and industrial base.

? Population

Bahrain's population reached approximately 1.7 million by 2025, driving consistent demand for imported consumer goods and industrial materials.

? GDP & Trade

Bahrain's GDP exceeded $44 billion USD. Imports represent approximately 28% of GDP — a structural dependency that makes trade analysis strategically vital.

? Economic Vision

Under Bahrain Vision 2030, diversification away from oil requires understanding and actively managing the country's import supply chains.

Key Facts 2025

$16.45B
Total imports

221
Source countries

6,335
Commodity types

324,818
Transactions

12
Months covered

What Problem Are We Solving?

WHAT

17.9% of all imports are just 2 commodities

Bahrain's import basket is dangerously concentrated. Aluminium oxide ($1.48B) and iron ore ($1.46B) together account for nearly one-fifth of total imports — a structural vulnerability.

WHEN

26% seasonal swing within a single year

Monthly imports range from $1.22B (June) to $1.53B (April). This 26% gap creates cash flow and supply chain planning challenges for import-dependent businesses.

WHO

Ministry of Industry, trade analysts, importers

Policymakers need to understand concentration risk. Analysts need trend data. Businesses need seasonal intelligence to plan procurement and inventory cycles.

HOW

Supply chain disruption, price spikes, lost competitiveness

A single supplier disruption (e.g., Australia's aluminium oxide) or a commodity price surge could materially impact Bahrain's industrial output and import costs.

OBJECTIVES

Four Analytical Questions

Q1

Source Country Concentration

Which countries are Bahrain's top import sources — and how concentrated is the dependency? Is Bahrain over-reliant on a small number of partners?

Q2

Commodity Basket Analysis

What are the top commodity categories by value? Are imports diversified across sectors or concentrated in a few industrial raw materials?

Q3

Seasonal Import Patterns

How do import volumes fluctuate across the 12 months of 2025? Are there predictable seasonal peaks and dips that businesses and policymakers should plan around?

Q4

Growth Signals & Emerging Trends

Which commodity categories grew the fastest in H2 2025 vs H1? What do these growth signals reveal about Bahrain's economic direction — particularly around energy transition?

About the Dataset

324,818
Total Transactions

$16.45B
Total Value (USD)

BD 6.19B
Total Value (BD)

221
Source Countries

6,335
Commodity Types

Source
Bahrain Open Data Portal — data.gov.bh
(Official Bahrain Government, Customs Affairs Authority)

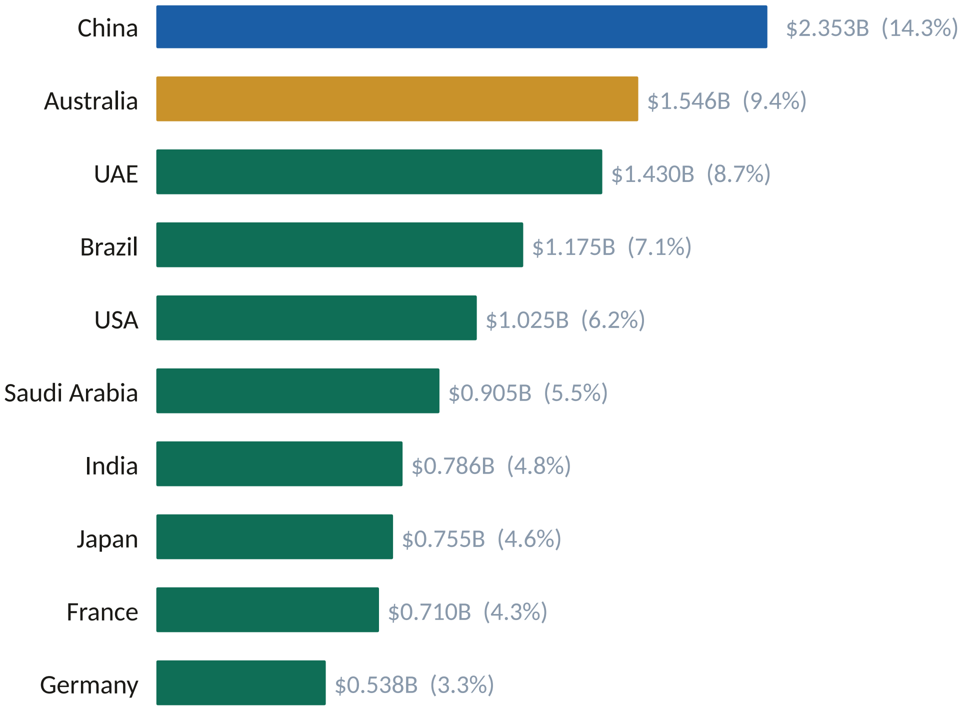
Coverage
January 2025 – December 2025
All 12 months · Full calendar year

Columns
12 fields: HS code, commodity, country, UN code,
import value (BD & USD), weight, quantity, unit of measure

Cleaning
0 nulls after cleaning · 0 duplicates
59 Namibia UN codes filled · 1 negative value flagged

Exchange Rate: 1 BD = 2.6596 USD — Fixed peg confirmed with zero variance across all 324,818 transactions

Where Does Bahrain Import From?



Key Insights

China leads at 14.3%

Supplies 4,600 unique commodity types — the most diverse partner by far.

Australia = one product

Australia's $1.55B is almost entirely aluminium oxide for ALBA. Remove it and Australia drops dramatically.

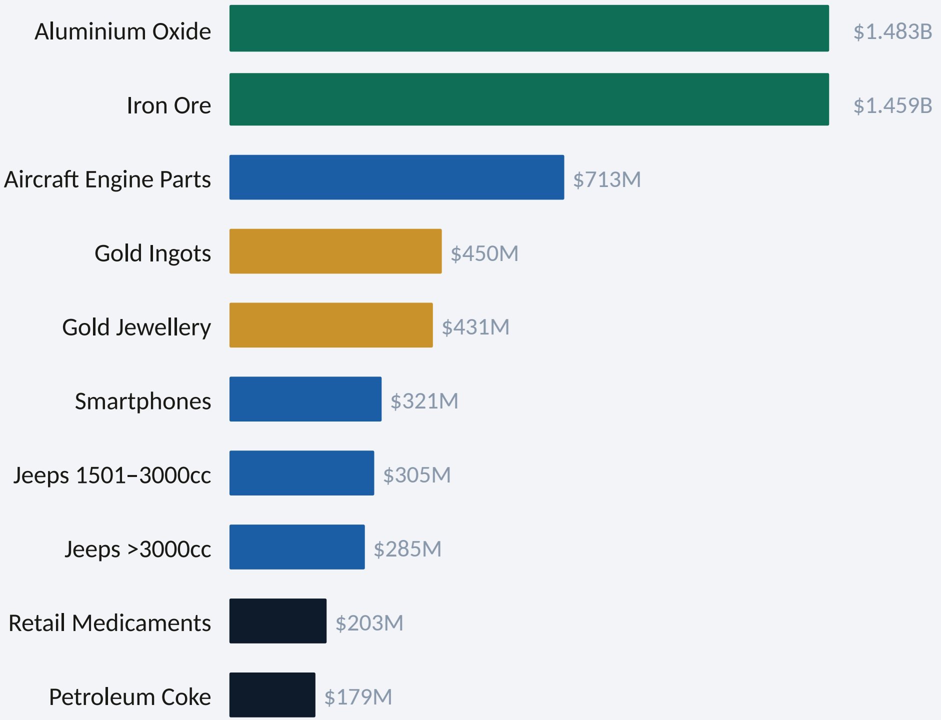
Top 3 = 32.4% of all imports

China, Australia, and UAE together control nearly a third of all imports — significant concentration risk.

Diversity vs. value gap

Switzerland imports rank lower by value but at $107.90/kg — the highest value density of any partner.

What Is Bahrain Actually Buying?



By Category

Industrial Raw 17.9%

Aluminium oxide + iron ore

Precious Metals 5.3%

Gold ingots + jewellery

Aerospace 4.3%

Aircraft engine parts

Consumer Goods 5.7%

Vehicles, phones, medicine

Top 2 commodities alone = 17.9% of all imports — Bahrain's industrial base drives extreme concentration

When Does Bahrain Buy the Most?

April — Peak — $1.530B

Post-Q1 restocking + pre-summer stocking drives highest import month

June — Dip — $1.215B

Summer slowdown reduces demand; lowest import month of the year

26% Swing — Apr vs Jun

Largest gap between any two months — significant planning implication

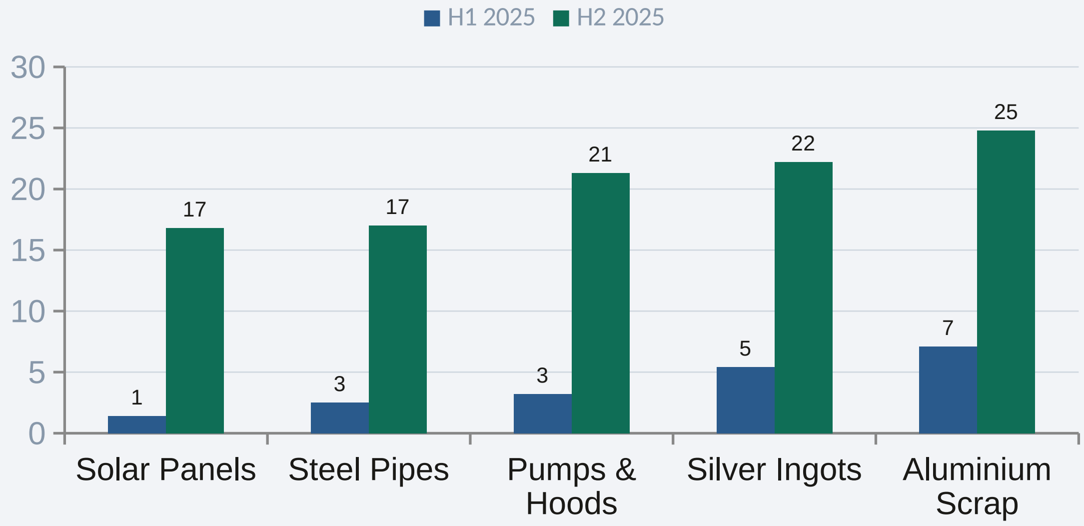
Dec — Strong — $1.515B

Year-end inventory builds create second-highest month of the year

What is Growing Fast?

+1,105%

Solar panel imports
H1 → H2 2025



+1,105%

+580%

+556%

+313%

+250%

The solar surge of +1,105% (H1→H2 2025) signals Bahrain's clean energy transition is already underway. Infrastructure investment must scale to match demand.

Strategic Actions for Bahrain

Q1 — **Diversify import partners for critical raw materials**

Develop alternative aluminium oxide suppliers (Guinea, Brazil, Jamaica). One country = one point of failure.

Q2 — **Build 90-day strategic reserves for industrial commodities**

Aluminium oxide + iron ore = 17.9% of all imports with inelastic demand. A buffer reserve protects industrial continuity.

Q3 — **Align procurement calendars to seasonal import cycles**

Front-load supplier contracts before April peaks; negotiate new deals in June–August when demand and prices are lower.

Q4 — **Invest in renewable energy import infrastructure now**

Solar panel imports grew 1,100%+ in H2. Customs, port, and logistics systems must scale to match the clean energy transition.

ALL — **Establish a trade intelligence monitoring unit at MOICT**

Real-time tracking of import concentration, country dependencies, and commodity growth signals — across all 221 partners.

LIMITATIONS

Honest Assessment of This Study

Single Year Only

No multi-year data available, making it impossible to distinguish 2025-specific anomalies from long-term structural trends. Year-over-year comparisons require 2022–2024 import data.

No Export Data

Without corresponding export records, a full trade balance analysis is not possible. Net trade position and re-export activity (especially via UAE) cannot be measured.

Predictive Model Accuracy

With only 12 monthly data points, all four time-series models returned low R^2 values (0.04–0.16). Forecasts are directionally valid but carry significant margin of error (~6–7%).

No GDP or Inflation Linkage

Import values cannot be expressed as a share of GDP or adjusted for inflation without supplemental macroeconomic data. This limits interpretation of real vs. nominal growth.

No Unit Pricing Standardization

Import value and quantity exist in different units (NO, KG, L, T, SQM etc.), making price-per-unit analysis across commodities unreliable without standardization.

Thank You

$16.45B	221	6,335	+1,105%
Total Imports	Countries	Commodities	Solar Growth

Yusuf Hakeem | DAP-PT-16 | 10 May 2026 | General Assembly

Data: data.gov.bh — Bahrain Open Data Portal (Official Government Source)